

THE
COMMUNICATIONS
AND ELECTRONICS BRANCH

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD
CFB KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4



BRANCHE
DES COMMUNICATIONS
ET DE L'ÉLECTRONIQUE

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD
BFC KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4

1180-5 (Br Adjt)

May 2024

Distribution List

SENATE MEETING
RECORD OF DECISIONS – FRIDAY, 26 MAY 2023

RECORD OF ATTENDANCE

POSITION / APPOINTMENT	RANK & NAME
Chair / Colonel Commandant	Brigadier-General Josée Robidoux (Retired)
Co-Chair / Branch Leader	Brigadier-General Dave Yarker
Member / Previous Colonel Commandant	Brigadier-General Kevin O'Keefe (Retired)
Member / Branch Advisor	Colonel John Roper
Member / Branch Chief	Chief Warrant Officer Alex Arndt
Member / Previous Branch Chief	Chief Warrant Officer Gilles Philibert
Member / Association President	Major-General John Leech (Retired)
Member / Foundation President	Mr. Scott Mclean
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Denis Boucher
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Pascal Godbout
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Patrice Sabourin (REGRETS)
Member / Serving General Officer	Brigadier-General Justin Thibert
Member / Honorary Rep	Colonel Ken Lloyd
Member / CO C&E Museum	Lieutenant-Colonel Bahir Ali
Guest / Museum Rep	Major Geoff Priems
Secretariat / Branch Adjutant	Major Gavin Ellis
Guest / C&E Home Station Staff Officer	Captain Simon Grant

OPENING REMARKS

1. Opening of Meeting:

The Colonel Commandant (Col Cmdt) opened the meeting at 1400 and offered initial opening remarks to the Branch Leader and Branch Chief.

REVIEW & APPROVAL OF PRIOR ROD

2. Colonel Commandant:

Approved as written.

OLD BUSINESS I – NETHERLANDS 2023 BACK-BRIEF AND NEXT STEPS

3. Colonel Commandant:

Troop engagement during the tour was excellent with numerous questions and interest at every stop including numerous questions to the historians hired to guide the group.

We proceeded (finally) to the plaque unveiling ceremony at the Signals Regiment where the Dutch troops introduced their tradition of “drinking the bitter” on parade, something our Canadian soldiers did participate in, although bewildered at first, and would like to bring to Canada. Additionally, Ms. Elizabeth Langford joined the tour during their cemetery tour and several battlefields stops and dined with the group on our last evening where we presented her with her own Netherland 2023 jacket and promoted her to the rank of Major. Ms Langford told her story and proceeded to a book signing of her book “By the Candlelight”.

Two flags were revealed: One with the 75th Anniversary and the other with 75+3 Anniversary printed on them. The group signed and presented them to at the Commanding Officer and RSM of the Dutch Signals Regiment along with the Semaphore to Satellite history book. The 75+3 flag was also signed by the Dutch soldiers and will be held by the LCol Lemaire until such time as a decision is made as to what should be done with it.

All additional funds from the trip were returned to the Foundation account to be put in reserve for future battlefield studies.

Three books were presented during the tour:

1. Dutch Signals Museum
2. Dutch Signals Regiment
3. A third group visited by the Battlefield tour.

Additionally, a history book was received from the Dutch Signals Regiment and will be provided to the Museum at the next possible time.

A “Super” Jimmy Day is being organized to allow the sponsors to meet some of soldiers who participated in the study to meet the requirements of the Branches commitment to our sponsors.

ACTION ITEM(s):

4. Colonel Commandant:

Decide what to do with the 75+3 Dutch-signed flag.

OLD BUSINESS II – HRH VISIT 2023 BACK-BRIEF

5. Colonel Commandant:

The Colonel Commandant, Branch Leader and Branch Chief attended the 8th Hussars anniversary weekend in Moncton where HRH Princess Anne, the C&E Branch Colonel-in-Chief met with several of our troops from across the country. The parade and overall reception were excellent.

2028 is the next anniversary for the Branch and it is recommended that the Branch engage with HRH secretary to start planning a visit during that time. This subject will be looked at in greater detail at the next Senate meeting in October.

OLD BUSINESS III – BOOK OF REMEMBRANCE – SEEKING DECISION – (SEE PARA 19 OF PREVIOUS ROD

6. Branch Adjutant:

Reviewed the proposal brought forward by BGen(ret) O’Keefe, to expand on the current book of remembrance artifact that resides in the C&E Museum. The proposal is to generate an additional book to capture those who were missed pre-1960’s and those who have passed since the initial book was created. It is recommended that the Branch use the same criteria set out by Veterans Affairs Canada and the department to define which of those who have passed qualify to be captured in the book. Additionally, it is recommended that a research group stood up to present a more conclusive list to the Senate with the Association to take lead on generating that research group.

Currently the Branch has five lists that can be consolidated, Joe Costello’s rcsigs.ca website, the Vimy Dedication List, and the BAC Book of Remembrance List that goes from 1947 to current time. These lists need to be analyzed and discrepancies are evaluated.

ACTION ITEM(s):

7. Association to create a cost analysis of creating a Second Book of Remembrance. With initial costs estimates being likely within the Association’s means.

OLD BUSINESS IV - C&E EDUCATIONAL BURSARIES

8. Branch Adjutant:

Are current Educational Bursaries totalling \$5000 still meeting the Branch's intent? Overall impression is that the bursaries were still a positive part of the Branch policy and should continue. There was review through discussion of amount paid, application criteria specifically related to sponsor contribution to P070.

Discussed discrepancy between Branch Standing Orders and CMCEN bursary totals and it was decided that the document of record must be the Standing Orders and those amounts and criteria should be reflected on CMCEN. A total of 5 bursaries of \$1000 are awarded divided as 3x bursaries for \$1000 for NCMs up to MWO and 2x bursaries for \$1000 for Officers. The division between NCM and Officers is deliberate as previously years have seen more submissions of better quality generally from Officer sponsors.

ACTION ITEM(s):

9. Update CMCEN to reflect totals in Branch Standing Orders.

OLD BUSINESS V – TIMELINE FOR H&R

10. Branch Adjutant:

Provided and update on H&R timeline and the expected events for 2023.

Comments for modification included moving the notification of bursary and H&R up to the April time frame to allow for additional input from reserve units. Additionally, communicating out to the membership who was successful in obtaining awards should be included in our overall communications plan.

It was commented that the work put into the awards was staff work heavy. On examination during the meeting, it was determined that for all but the Subaltern and Member of the year nominations the Branch leverages that same simple forms that other awards require. The heritage form is slightly different as it is required to include civilian nominations, but the perceived quantity of work required to complete these nominations is limited.

ACTION ITEM(s):

11. Branch Office to examine the required staff work for each award and provide recommendations at the next Senate meeting.

OLD BUSINESS VI – RCEME MOU

12. The Branch Advisor forwarded the signed MOU to the Branch Leader for final signature the day prior to the Senate meeting.

OLD BUSINESS VII – BRANCH COMMUNICATIONS PLAN
13. Colonel Commandant: It was previously determined that the Branch requires help and support to generate a communications plan to better advertise to our members and to generate interest. Additionally, it was also recognized that there were little to no funds available to support such an initiative. 14. Foundation President: Not opposed to fund raising to support this initiative. A plan is required to reverse the lowering levels of P070 funds and to generate interest in funding the Branch from the new generation that is joining the CAF. Presented at the same time was historical information regarding a working group that stood up prior to the pandemic as well a Communications Plan generated by the Association that would be picked up and followed by a member or team who is found for this purpose. 15. Branch Advisor: Discussed possibility of a Reservist Class A Public Affairs Officer Branch position to alleviate some advertising issues. ACTION ITEM(s): 16. Branch Office to examine the potential of standing up a Public Affairs position.
NEW BUSINESS I – C&E WEEK 2023 (23-28 OCT 22)
17. Branch Advisor: Presented 2x Courses of action (COA) in slides 15-20 of Annex A for C&E Week 2023 with a third being eliminated but provided for reference. It is recommended that COA 1 be selected. After a brief discussion, the Branch Leader approved COA 1 with a recommendation from the Association for a dedicated a time within C&E Week for Veteran representation. ACTION ITEM(s): 18. Branch Adjutant: Draft C&E Week 2023 Warning Order for June 3rd.
NEW BUSINESS II – Branch Report
19. Branch Adjutant:

Provided a summary of financial expenditures as per Slide 7 of Annex A . Highlighted during this summary included:

- 120 Years of the C&E Branch;
- \$2000 in C&E Branch Office expenses;
- Temporary civilian hire for the C&E Garrison Band Bandmaster position with HSSO Captain Grant as POC;
- Possibility of a PAFFO for the Branch Office in Kingston;
- Master Corporal Position for the Branch Office in Kingston;
- Twitter: @CMCEN_RCMCE and,
- Facebook: <https://www.facebook.com/RCMCE.CMCEN>.

ACTION ITEM(s):

20. **Branch Office:** Requested that the staff looks at CMCEN and ensures that all governance documentation for the Association and Branch are available for review by all membership.

NEW BUSINESS III – MUSEUM REPORT

21. OC Museum:

Provided an overview of the C&E Museum as seen within Slides 8-11 of Annex A, while highlighting that employee wages are the largest cost to the Museum with an expected 6% increase - \$20 000 increase compared to 2022.

A recommendation to include all aspects of the budget including funding from CFB Kingston as well as other salary-based revenue and expenses was asked.

A detailed report of the 7% profit on Mercury Shop sales are not profit but to cost recovery. Current merchandise costs are inline or above CANEX, and the Museum needs to review shipping costs.

It is recommended sell Mercury Shop merchandise through Unit Kit shops in bulk and at a 10% discount.

Discussed Museum-grade display cases which ballooned in price from \$3000 pre-covid to \$15000 during covid, down to \$12000 post-covid. With 200x exhibits at \$15000 per case that's a \$4 million overhaul. Requesting DHH fund the whole endeavour over time.

NEW BUSINESS IV – FOUNDATION REPORT

22. LCol(Ret) Scott McLean:

Indicated that the foundation was in good shape. The funds invested are doing well and it is expected that in further years additional funds can be provided to the Museum.

Concerned about the Board of Director's age and demographic: mostly older than 63 years old. Several new military members are generating Foundation activities which will hopefully breath new life into the BoD.

A reinvigoration of funding strategies is required. New ways of going out to our members and outside the membership to enable increased flow of funds to the Foundation. A fee for membership has purposely been not looked at to generate more revenue for the Foundation for concern that this will further alienate the membership.

NEW BUSINESS IV – ASSOCIATION REPORT

23. Association President:

Association has received an influx of funds from the folding of the Signalers Club which helped the Association after multiple years of not holding any activities due to COVID. These new funds are fenced to Cultural and historical activities. The increased number of deployments will impact Op JIMMY SANTA costs, but this is seen as a positive item.

Several new members have joined the Association Board:

- New secretary, Sergeant Christian Marcot.
- Development understudy to begin with Corporal David Tran located in Calgary.

Propose a revival of retired officers and senior NCO dinner in 2024.

Proposed the establishment of a Branch Working Group to examine the Historical aspects of the Branch and to support the collection of historical information. Which was supported by the Senate.

CLOSING REMARKS

24. Additional discussion regarding the 125th C&E Anniversary that the Association may want to coordinate internally.

25. Capstone Foundation documents need to be reviewed and updated to the Senate, in Terms of membership, affiliation, and representation. As well as a Strategic Direction for the Senate was previously drafted and approved by the Senate, it should be found and either tabled or dismissed should it not be relevant.

ACTION ITEM(s):

26. Branch office to find and review current Senate governance documentation for discussion and review at a future Senate meeting.

ROBIDOUX, JOSEE 589

Digitally signed by ROBIDOUX,
JOSEE 589
Date: 2024.05.28 08:21:29 -04'00'

Brigadier-General Josée Robidoux, OMM, CD (Retired)
Branch Colonel Commandant



Digitally signed by YARKER, DAVID
516
Date: 2024.06.01 13:57:16 -04'00'

Brigadier-General Dave Yarker, CD
Branch Leader

Annexes:

Annex A Branch Senate Slide Deck

C&E BRANCH SENATE MEETING



Friday, 26 1400 May 2023

Slide 1

AGENDA:

- ▶ Opening Remarks (**Branch Leadership**)
- ▶ Review and Approval of Previous Minutes (**Colonel Commandant**)
- ▶ Old Business I - Netherlands 2023 Back Brief and Next Steps (**Colonel Commandant**)
- ▶ Old Business II - HRH Visit 2023 Back Brief (**Colonel Commandant**)
- ▶ Old Business III - Book of Remembrance - Seeking Decision (**Colonel Commandant**)
- ▶ Old Business IV - C&E Educational Bursaries (**Colonel Commandant**)
- ▶ Old Business V - Timeline for H&R (**Colonel Commandant**)
- ▶ Old Business VI - RCEME MOU (**Colonel Commandant**)
- ▶ Old Business VII - Branch Communications Plan (**Colonel Commandant**)
- ▶ New Business I - C&E Week 2023 (23 -28 Oct 22) (**Branch Advisor**)
- ▶ New Business II - Branch Report (**Branch Advisor & Branch Adjutant**)
- ▶ New Business III - Museum Report (**Officer Commanding Museum**)
- ▶ New Business IV - Foundation Report (**Foundation President**)
- ▶ New Business V - Association Report (**Association President**)
- ▶ Closing Remarks (**ALCON**)

Slide 2

INTRODUCTORY REMARKS

- ▶ Branch Leader
- ▶ Colonel Commandant
- ▶ Branch Chief

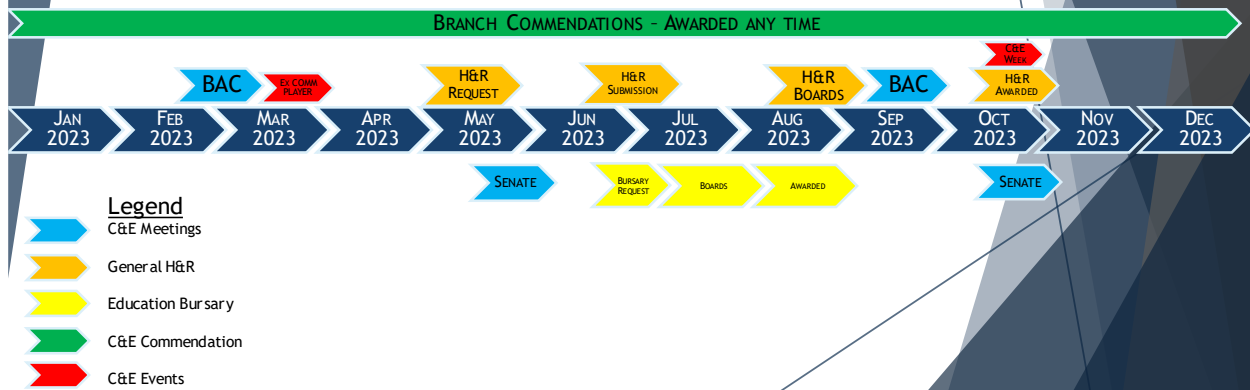
Slide 3

Old Business

- ▶ Netherlands 2023 Back Brief and Next Steps (Colonel Commandant)
- ▶ HRH Visit 2023 Back Brief (Colonel Commandant)
- ▶ Book of Remembrance - Seeking Decision (Colonel Commandant)
- ▶ C&E Educational Bursaries (Colonel Commandant)
- ▶ Timeline for H&R (Colonel Commandant)
- ▶ RCEME MOU (Colonel Commandant)
- ▶ Branch Communications Plan (Colonel Commandant)

Slide 4

C&E Event Schedule Macro Overview 2023



Slide 5

New Business

- ▶ C&E Week 2023 (23-28 Oct 22) (Branch Advisor)
- ▶ Branch Report (Branch Advisor & Branch Adjutant)
- ▶ Museum Report (Officer Commanding Museum)
- ▶ Foundation Report (Foundation President)
- ▶ Association Report (Association President)

Slide 6

Branch Report

- ▶ FY 23/24 Budget
 - ▶ \$2,900.00 Events
 - ▶ \$2,500.00 C&E Week (Oct) (C&E Branch Office)
 - ▶ \$2,000.00 C&E Week - Unit Celebrations
 - ▶ \$9,000.00 Funds (Distress and Education)
 - ▶ \$2,000.00 Office Expenses
 - ▶ **\$18,300.00 Total**
- ▶ HR
- ▶ CMCEN / Social Media

Slide 7

Museum Report

- ▶ Budget
- ▶ Mercury Shop
- ▶ MDF Submission 2023

Slide 8

23/24 Budget

Revenue

Category	Budgeted
Donation-Foundation REV	\$159,000.00
Donation- RCEME REV	\$35,000.00
Donation Box REV	\$1,730.00
Curatorial/EDU (Edu Program Ops)REV	\$2,200.00
Curatorial/EDU (Outreach Program Ops)REV	\$13,600.00
Sponsorship and Development	\$48,000.00
Admission	\$20,300.00
Rental Revenue	\$2,400.00
Special Events Function	\$-
Total	\$282,230.00

18/19 support was \$200k

Budget Gap -growing year to year, now about 20%

Expenses

Personnel (fixed cost, except wage increases)	\$208,569.40
Social Media/Marketing (discretionary)	\$13,150.00
Travel/TD	\$13,120.00
Postage	\$2,100.00
Special Events/Outreach	\$5,500.00
Hospitality	\$750.00
Supplies	\$13,253.00
Education Program	\$7,820.00
Printing/Reproduction	\$1,200.00
Furniture	\$4,900.00
Curatorial	\$11,200.00
Covid-19	\$600.00
Total	\$282,162.40

10% increase, ~\$20k

Slide 9

Mercury Shop

Concerns expressed over cost of items and shipping

- ▶ COGS has increased in general. Shipping cost increased even more.
- ▶ Prices for required items for military members gives a less than 10% profit margin
 - ▶ We understand we are a monopoly when it comes to these items
 - ▶ Will continue to review suppliers
 - ▶ At least 3 suppliers went out of business during/as a result of COVID
- ▶ Prices for all other items (I.E. general public) seeking 25% margin
 - ▶ Our prices are in line (and cannot compete or be cost less) with CANEX
 - ▶ Shipping continuously reviewed
 - ▶ We have best shipping rate at present (Purolator govt business acct, Canada Post)
 - ▶ Shipping costs are regional in nature (ON, QC, West, Maritimes, Territories, NL)
 - ▶ Best to use Unit kit shops to save on price (10%) and bulk shipping

Slide 10

MDF Submission 2023

2022 re-submissions (\$1,738k):

- ▶ Permanent Gallery Renewal Study(\$50k; Step one for complete Museum up
- ▶ Display Acquisition (\$900k; Step two; \$4m overall project (materials only)
- ▶ Interpretive Panels and Signs(\$250k; Step three)
- ▶ Museum Storage (\$500k+)
- ▶ Website Maintenance (\$10k; needed to continue the Museum's DAMP)
- ▶ Conservation Supplies (\$25k; always needed)
- ▶ OMMC Travel Expenses (\$2.5k; annual expense).

2023 new submissions (\$1,738k +\$55k =\$1,793k)

- ▶ Security system update(\$5k)
- ▶ Audio Tour App(\$10k)
- ▶ Line Refreshment Project(\$30k) *
- ▶ March of the Museums(\$10k)

*March of the Museums \$20k + \$20k fund raised by Line Communities

Slide 11



Foundation Report

- ▶ Board of Directors
- ▶ Finances
- ▶ Fundraising

Slide 12

C&E ASSOCIATION REPORT

- ▶ Association Update
- ▶ Establishment of a C&E History Working Group
- ▶ Veteran Inclusion – C&E Week and other events

Slide 13

Closing Remarks

Slide 14

C&E Week - Themes

- ▶ Looking to the Future
- ▶ 120th Year of C&E Branch
- ▶ Reconstitution and the C&E Branch

Slide 15

C&E Week - Common Elements

- ▶ Maximum use of Virtual Means
- ▶ Keynote Address
- ▶ History and Culture
 - The Subalterns & Sergeants Indoctrination Program
 - Major Carruthers Gravesite Ceremony;
 - Mess Dinners
- ▶ Symposiums / Presentations
 - C&E Association PD Symposium;
 - The C&E Family Update;
- ▶ Collaboration/Conferences:
 - Working Groups;
 - Environmental Conferences:
- ▶ Exercise NOBLE SKYWAVE

Slide 16

COA 1: Fix It (Juniors Learn, Seniors Fix)

	23 Oct(Mon)	24 Oct(Tue)	25 Oct(Wed)	26 Oct(Thu)	27 Oct(Fri)	28 Oct(Sat)
A6 CAPCON						
G6 Conference						
Sub/Sgt Indoc						
AM	Keynote	Carruthers	Association PD	Work Grps Intro	Work Grps	Wrk Grps(-3) Pres
PM	Branch Update	Coffee w/ Veterans	Association PD/AGM	Work Grps	Work Grps Assessment	
Evening	Assoc. Meet & Greet (NCR)		Branch Meet & Greet	Field Dinner	Formal Mess Dinner	

Location: Kingston

Key Adds:

- Coffee w/veterans
- Friday Mess Dinners
- C&E Leadership participate in Saturday PRes Conf
- Late Branch Update to allow more PRes participation

Positives:

- Deliberate Working Group Framework
- Increased PRes Participation

Challenges:

- Dinner Attd.
- Longer Week for Snr members

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Slide 17

COA 2: Leadership in NCR

	23 Oct(Mon)	24 Oct(Tue)	25 Oct(Wed)	26 Oct(Thu)	27 Oct(Fri)	28 Oct(Sat)
AM	Keynote Sub / Sgt Indoc (2 days)	Carruthers	Association PD		Wrk Grps Presentations	
PM	Branch Update	Coffee w/ Veterans	Association PD/AGM	Work Grps		PRes Conf (NCR/Virtual)
Evening		Joint Assoc/Branch Meet&Greet	"Fix It"	Formal Mess Dinner		

Location: Split

(NCR/Kingston/Virtual)

Key Adds:

- Juniors (Kingston) and Seniors (NCR) are split
- Juniors focus on Hist Heritage
- Dinners on Thursday
- All Environmental Co. Ottawa

Positives:

- Junior/Snr participation
- Deliberate Working Group Framework
- Easier Snr Participation

Challenges:

- Cost
- Logistic/IT in NCR
- Junior/Snr networking

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Slide 18

COA 3: Status Quo (LL/Accom. Multiple Timezones)

	23 Oct(Mon)	24 Oct(Tue)	25 Oct(Wed)	26 Oct(Thu)	27 Oct(Fri)	28 Oct(Sat)
A6 CAPCON						
G6 Conference						
Sub/Sgt Indoc						
AM	Keynote Coffee w/ Veterans	Carruthers	Association PD	Wrk Grps Intro	Wrk Grps	Wrk Grps Presentations
PM			Association PD/AGM	Wrk Grps	Branch Update	
Evening	Assoc. Meet & Greet(NCR)		Field Dinner	Branch Meet & Greet	Formal Mess Dinner	

Location: Kingston

Key Adds:

- 1000 start to allow PST participation
- Friday Mess Dinner
- Afternoon Branch Update

Positives:

- Longer Wrk Groups
- Increased PRes Participation
- Similar to 2022
- Increased virtual Attd. By West Coast

Challenges:

- Dinner Attd.
- Longer Week for Snr members

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Slide 19

Recommended Actions

- ▶ Each major event is assigned to a unit for completion:
- ▶ Ensure that all activities are planned such that they meet all [Strat/Op](#) objectives of CAF Reconstitution.
- ▶ D365 leveraged to document and record all presentation and Working group activities.
- ▶ Working Groups of 10-12 members are lead by COs, hosted virtually and in person.

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Slide 20